BOT-20261019-ORGANIC-EXC-03 — Final Completed Task Report

LEDSone UK — Locale URLs Competing with English Pages — 2026-10-20 | **PASS**

STORE	TICKET	STATUS
ledsone.co.uk	BOT-20261019-ORGANIC-EXC-03	Fix Live & Verified

OPENED	CLOSED	INVESTIGATOR
2026-10-19	2026-10-20	Piranav + Claude Code

1 Problem Statement

Polish (/pl/), Dutch (/nl/) and Spanish (/es/) locale URLs generated by Shopify Markets were appearing in UK Google Search Console and competing with the English pages.

Metric	Value (28 days to 2026-10-19)
Locale URLs in UK GSC	2,612
Total impressions (all locales, UK)	25,068
Total clicks	20
CTR	0.08%
/pl/ UK impressions (verified, 28 days to 2026-10-20)	14,600
/pl/ UK clicks	5
/pl/ UK average position	26.2

2 Markets Decision

All 3 locale markets were confirmed as required for international customers. No removal, noindex or redirects were applied.

Market	Locale	Decision
UK Market	/en/ (default)	**Retained**
EU Market	/pl/ Polish	**Retained — required for international customers**
Netherlands Market	/nl/ Dutch	**Retained — required for international customers**
International	/es/ Spanish	**Retained — required for international customers**

3 Investigation Findings

Self-referencing Canonicals
theme.liquid line 53 — `{{ canonical_url }}` confirmed working on all pages including locale URLs. No defect.

Custom hreflang Code
seo-noindex.liquid — custom loop written 2025-10-12 is entirely commented out. Not active, not causing any issue.

Root Cause — Missing en-GB
Shopify Markets outputs `hreflang="en"` only (language-only, no region). No en-GB exists — Google has no UK signal for English pages.

Markets Auto-hreflang
Markets correctly outputs en, pl, nl, es, x-default, nl-NL (ledsone.nl) via content_for_header. No defect — only en-GB missing.

hreflang Tags Present Before Fix

```
<link rel="alternate" hreflang="x-default" href="https://ledsone.co.uk/products/...">
<link rel="alternate" hreflang="en"        href="https://ledsone.co.uk/products/...">
<link rel="alternate" hreflang="es"        href="https://ledsone.co.uk/es/products/...">
<link rel="alternate" hreflang="pl"        href="https://ledsone.co.uk/pl/products/...">
<link rel="alternate" hreflang="nl"        href="https://ledsone.co.uk/nl/products/...">
<link rel="alternate" hreflang="nl-NL"     href="https://ledsone.nl/products/...">
❌ hreflang="en-GB"  ← MISSING
```

4 Fix Applied

One file changed — applies automatically to all 2,612+ pages.

File: `shopify_projects/ledsone-uk-theme/snippets/seo-noindex.liquid` — rendered on every page via theme.liquid line 148.

```
{%- comment -%} en-GB hreflang — Markets outputs 'en' (language-only);
this adds UK region signal piranav 2026-10-20 {%- endcomment -%}
{%- for locale in shop.published_locales -%}
```

```
    {%- if locale.iso_code == 'en' -%}
      {%- if request.locale.iso_code == 'en' -%}
        {%- assign en_canonical = canonical_url -%}
      {%- else -%}
        {%- assign en_canonical = canonical_url | replace: request.locale.root_url, '' -%}
      {%- endif -%}
      <link rel="alternate" hreflang="en-GB" href="{{ en_canonical }}">
      {%- break -%}
    {%- endif -%}
  {%- endfor -%}
```

How It Works

Scenario	Logic	Output
English page (`/products/...`)	`en_canonical = canonical_url`	`ledsone.co.uk/products/...`
Polish page (`/pl/products/...`)	Strip `/pl` from canonical_url	`ledsone.co.uk/products/...`
Dutch page (`/nl/products/...`)	Strip `/nl` from canonical_url	`ledsone.co.uk/products/...`
Spanish page (`/es/products/...`)	Strip `/es` from canonical_url	`ledsone.co.uk/products/...`

5 Verification

Test URL: `https://ledsone.co.uk/products/screw-e27-light-bulb-lamp-holder-base-pendant-socket`

Check	Page	Result
hreflang="en-GB" present	English page	✓ **PASS**
href = English URL	English page	✓ **PASS**
hreflang="en-GB" present	/pl/ page	✓ **PASS**
href points to English URL (no /pl/)	/pl/ page	✓ **PASS**
No double slash in href	Both pages	✓ **PASS**
Existing Markets tags untouched	Both pages	✓ **PASS**

Full hreflang Set After Fix

```
<link rel="alternate" hreflang="x-default" href="https://ledsone.co.uk/products/...">
<link rel="alternate" hreflang="en"         href="https://ledsone.co.uk/products/...">
<link rel="alternate" hreflang="es"         href="https://ledsone.co.uk/es/products/...">
<link rel="alternate" hreflang="pl"         href="https://ledsone.co.uk/pl/products/...">
<link rel="alternate" hreflang="nl"         href="https://ledsone.co.uk/nl/products/...">
<link rel="alternate" hreflang="nl-NL"      href="https://ledsone.nl/products/...">
<link rel="alternate" hreflang="en-GB"      href="https://ledsone.co.uk/products/...">  ← NEW
```

6 Evidence

#	File	Description
E01	gsc-pl-uk-correct-5clicks-14k-impressions-2026-10-20.png	GSC UK /pl/ baseline — 5 clicks, 14.6K impressions, position 26.2
E02	gsc-pl-uk-daily-trend-sep20-oct16-2026-10-20.png	GSC daily trend — /pl/ UK, Sep 20 – Oct 16 2026
E03	BOT-20261019-ORGANIC-EXC-03_SEO-Investigation-Report.pdf	Original investigation report — 67 screenshots, 6.9MB
E04	gsc-en-gb-verified-english-page-2026-10-20.png	Live source — en-GB on English page ✓
E05	gsc-en-gb-verified-pl-page-2026-10-20.png	Live source — en-GB on /pl/ page, correct href ✓

7 Git Commits

Commit	Description
`c85f4af`	Initial AIOS task folder + investigation records
`3b14a37`	en-GB hreflang fix + verification evidence (seo-noindex.liquid)
`d0fae3c`	Final closure entry — PASS
`d6d00c7`	Final completed task report

8 Expected Outcome

- Google re-crawls ledsone.co.uk and updates hreflang signals within **1–4 weeks**
- UK users served English pages preferentially, regardless of browser language preference
- Polish / Dutch / Spanish locale pages remain fully accessible for international customers
- GSC UK impressions for locale URLs expected to decline in the next 28-day reporting window
- No pages removed, noindexed, or redirected — zero risk to international traffic

9 Safety Confirmation

Area	Status
Shopify Markets settings	**Unchanged**
Locale URLs (/pl/, /nl/, /es/)	**All retained — no removal or noindex**
Redirects / robots.txt / DNS	**Unchanged**
Files changed	`snippets/seo-noindex.liquid` only — 9 lines added